

The 2026 Digital States Survey winners have been announced. [Read more](#)

JUSTICE & PUBLIC SAFETY

NYPD Reviews Use of Flock Safety AI License Plate Readers

The New York City Police Department is examining its use of the nationwide license plate reader network, which uses AI. The agency

September 30, 2026 • Rocco Parascandola, New York Daily News



A Flock camera is mounted to a pole on Sept. 14, 2026, in Glendale, California. U.S. President Donald Trump expressed support for Flock cameras, saying he likes the AI-powered surve

(TNS) — The NYPD is reviewing hundreds of instances in which officers used [Flock Safety](#), a controversial nationwide license plate reader network. The department has also enacted new rules about officers using outside vendors without approval, but a department spokesman said “The current administration wanted to create a single centralized process for vendor engagement,” a department spokesman said abc

The new rules also update “the ethical guidelines that members of the service must follow in all interactions with vendors,” the NYPD : The NYPD has never had a contract with Flock, nor does it share any data with the company, a There is no indication that officers violated any department rules by using Flock, the department

It is also unclear why the department has not previously established the guidelines about outside

By clicking “Accept All Cookies”, you agree to the storing of cookies on your device to enhance site navigation, analyze site usage, and assist in our marketing efforts.

Accept All Cookies

Reject All

Flock, which declined to comment, uses artificial intelligence to identify vehicles being sought by [New York City](#) police.

Nearly all the NYPD searches using Flock are believed to involve suspects who have fled the city.

The NYPD in October told Flock it was not interested in entering into a contract, in part because the department already works with ar

Currently, Flock has a small presence in the city and is used by a few private companies and corporate-owned chains such as Home I

Civil rights organizations like [LatinoJustice](#) determined that NYPD officers used Flock 1,710 times between March 2023 and last Dece

“We just don’t know what so many of these searches are for,” said Andrew Case, a LatinoJustice lawyer. “And you have to wonder wh

“The idea that a vendor could walk up to a sergeant or a detective and say, ‘I’ll give you free access to our database and no one in the

Eleni Manis, research director for [Surveillance Oversight Technology Project](#), or S.T.O.P., said she hopes the Freedom of Information

“It’s at least 24 officers who used Flock, but there’s an awful lot of blanks,” she said, referring to the spreadsheet made public Sept. 17

Civil libertarians have blasted Flock, viewing it as more evidence that American life is under more surveillance than ever. Flock camer

Some police forces have been criticized for not establishing rules about its use, with one Texas cop caught using Flock more than [10](#)!

The NYPD said its contract with Vigilant routinely aids in investigations and leads to arrests. The department’s own license plate read

Two of the suspects have been charged, while the third is still being sought.

LatinoJustice and S.T.O.P. learned of the NYPD officers using Flock from [Have I Been Flocked](#), a website which tracks responses to p

©2026 New York Daily News, Distributed by [Tribune Content Agency, LLC](#).

Tags:

NEW YORK CITY

JUSTICE AND PUBLIC SAFETY

PRIVACY

GOVTECH TODAY

Delivered daily to your inbox to stay on top of the latest state & local government technology

Email Address*

By clicking “Accept All Cookies”, you agree to the storing of cookies on your device to enhance site navigation, analyze site usage, and assist in our marketing efforts.

FREE NEWSLETTER SIGN UP

RELATED CONTENT

Honolulu Police Chief Wants to Expand Staff, Tech Use

September 30, 2026

Audit Scrutinizes Seattle Police Use of Traffic Cameras

September 30, 2026

Flagstaff, Ariz., Police Move Dispatch, Records to the Cloud

September 29, 2026

Connecticut Police Council Seeks Changes to Camera Rules

September 29, 2026

With 'Noise Cameras,' West Haven, Conn., Targets Loud Cars

September 25, 2026

After Flock Ban, These South Florida Cameras Will Remain

September 24, 2026

mmMwWLlilOfiflO&1
mmMwWLlilOfiflO&1
mmMwWLlilOfiflO&1

By clicking "Accept All Cookies", you agree to the storing of cookies on your device to enhance site navigation, analyze site usage, and assist in our marketing efforts.

mmMwWLiI0fiflO&1
mmMwWLiI0fiflO&1
—
mmMwWLiI0fiflO&1



By clicking "Accept All Cookies", you agree to the storing of cookies on your device to enhance site navigation, analyze site usage, and assist in our marketing efforts.